

Your pregnancy is well-established as the risk of miscarriage drops significantly, and you may enjoy a resurgence of energy now. The fetus grows dramatically, and your abdomen will soon develop a rounded belly.

16 WEEKS You will definitely start to look pregnant now, even if you don't feel that different.



Baby watch

📏 5½ in (13 cm) ⚖️ 5 oz (140 g)

The fetus is now larger than the placenta. The torso and limbs are growing quickly, and head growth slows, so the fetus looks more in proportion. You may hear your baby's heartbeat for the first time now as your doctor listens in with a fetal heart monitor that is placed on your abdomen to measure sound waves.

Mom matters

A rise in the production of melanin, the pigment that gives your skin and hair its color, can create temporary skin changes. Dark patches, called "chloasma," may appear on your cheeks, forehead, upper lip, and neck. You may develop a dark vertical line down your abdomen, called a linea nigra. These lighten or disappear after birth.



This week...

- » Your doctor will talk to you about the anatomy scan (ultrasound) due soon. If blood tests revealed you were anemic, you may be offered iron supplements.
- » If you wear contact lenses, you may find your eyes are drier than usual. Your optician can give you special drops.
- » Dieting isn't recommended in pregnancy; try to stick to fresh, healthy foods.

17 WEEKS The bloom of pregnancy may be showing in your skin, and even in your mood.



Baby watch

📏 5½ in (14.2 cm) ⚖️ 6¼ oz (190 g)

The baby's sexual organs are well-developed now and will be clearly visible. By the end of this week, all your baby's milk teeth buds have formed and are nestled in place under the gums.

Mom matters

Your heart is now working at twice its normal rate to pump the increased blood volume around your body. To deal with this extra volume of blood and stop your blood pressure from rising, your blood vessels become more flexible and dilate. As more blood is diverted to the skin, you may look positively glowing and healthy. You may have a renewed interest in sex, helped by the increased blood flow to the pelvic area.



This week...

- » Due to hormonal changes you may feel hotter than usual; dress in breathable fabrics or layers you can adjust.
- » Support your baby's developing nervous system by eating foods containing omega-3 fatty acids, such as fish that's low in mercury, flaxseed and olive oil. Don't eat more than 8 to 12 ounces of low-mercury fish each week.
- » While your energy levels may have picked up, be careful not to overdo things. Plan plenty of relaxation time.

18 WEEKS You may experience your baby's early, fluttering movements. These are known as "quickenings."



Baby watch

📏 6 in (15.3 cm) ⚖️ 8½ oz (240 g)

Your baby increasingly resembles the little person you will meet. Facial features are well formed and unique fingerprints have begun to develop. Though the eyelids are still shut, the eyeballs can move from side to side.

Mom matters

You may feel your baby move for the very first time from this point. These early movements are known as "quickenings" and can feel like a fluttery sensation. Each week your uterus grows around ¾ in (1 cm), and the top of the uterus (the fundus) is almost level with your belly button. The ligaments that support the pelvic area stretch and thin, which can cause hip and back pain.



This week...

- » Your anatomy scan (ultrasound) takes place around this time, so think ahead as to whether or not you want to discover your baby's sex.
- » As your belly becomes ever more prominent, you may attract comments on your appearance and people may want to touch your belly. It is fine to ask people not to.
- » Your changing shape and size means your center of gravity shifts, and you may feel a little wobbly. It may be time to put your high heels aside.